

Being Filled With the Spirit

We have been breaking this down, this now faith, this faith for crisis, this faith for problems right now. We interrupted a study on intercession, which changes the course of your whole life. Right in the middle of that, He began to move on me to study for a little while the kind of faith that changes things immediately.

So we started looking at the kind of faith that pleases God. Look again with me at Hebrews 11:6:

But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.

We found out that in order to have faith that pleases God, the kind of faith I must come to Him with has to have these two qualifications. Number one, it must believe that He is. Number two, it must believe that He is a rewarder of those who give their time to diligently seek Him.

So to have faith that pleases God, first you must believe that He is. That qualifies it to even be faith. Then, to qualify it as faith that pleases God, you must believe that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

As faith people, we found out that God is not our problem. He is our answer. He is not sin, sickness, and disease. He is the One who healed us. He is not the One breaking you and draining your checking account. He is the One who substituted Himself in your poverty, and so on.

If there is one foundation the faith move has given us, it is this:

Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God.

God cannot be tempted, tested, or tried with evil, neither does He tempt or try any man with evil. Mark 4 says all persecution, affliction, and the cares of this world arise for one reason: to choke the Word of God, in other words, to cancel its operation in your life before it can produce its answer.

One thing the faith move has done is give us a good foundation that qualifies us to have faith that pleases God. Not only must we believe that He is, but that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

Unless you have faith that declares He is, you are not even approaching Him with faith. It is impossible for you to please Him.

That phrase, "he that cometh to God must believe that he is," even though it is not capitalized here, is the same thing as when Moses was addressed by God in the wilderness. Moses said, "Who shall I tell Pharaoh sent me?" God said, "Tell him that I AM sent you."

When you come before God with faith that pleases Him, you must believe that He is. When God addressed Moses in the first person, He said, "I AM." He simply is the sum total of everything that exists, past, present, and future. But to you, who are coming to Him in the present now, you must believe that He is.

It is one of the names of God that describes His essence. He says, "I simply am the sum total of everything that exists." To have faith that pleases God, you must come to Him believing that He is everything He said He is in your covenant, or you do not have faith that pleases Him.

This is where we get God's sovereignty: from positional truth. Positional truth is when Jesus passed through the cross and set a divine law into operation, which is His sovereignty.

That divine law says He provided salvation for every man, woman, and child. When any person meets the qualification, a law kicks in and that person will be born again. It is positional truth. It is sovereign. As long as our covenant holds and people need to be born again, there is not a man, woman, or child who will ever come before God, believe with the heart that God raised Jesus from the dead, and not be born again.

It is a law as positive as the law of gravity. When you throw a rock off a building, it will fall at a certain velocity. You can put calculations to it and figure out exactly what it will do.

God is sovereign because He has divine law. One divine law is in salvation. When you come to Him, you must believe that He is what He said He is, and that pleases Him.

He said the same thing about your healing. People do not like to believe it because we fight for a reason that we are sick. The devil has been successful in deceiving the body of Christ into believing there are other reasons for being sick that are somehow held with God. In other words, it is not you or anything you are doing, but God is withholding healing because it was predestined for you to die of this disease. Or He has something valuable to teach you, and in His estimation you can learn it no other way.

The devil will come with lots of real good-sounding doctrines and pull us away from positional truth. Then it becomes impossible to please God because we cannot come to Him believing that He is, because we do not know what He is.

But in positional truth, mark this down: He absolutely provided healing for you. Two thousand years ago He bore your sicknesses and carried your pains. He has made healing available by divine law in His sovereignty to every man, woman, and child who can believe for it.

When you meet the condition, that is, when you pass into that healing by faith, then it is law. He is not sitting on the throne picking out people He will heal and people He will not heal. It is absolutely sovereign. It is a matter of attaining to it.

A man who comes to God first must believe. You first must believe. You have to settle this: that He is, that He is, that He is.

He takes it into prosperity in Matthew 6. Five times He says, "Take no thought for your life." Your heavenly Father has made provision for every day of your life, what you will eat, wear, and drink. He says, "Why do you give yourself over to the cares of this world and fill yourself with so much turmoil that God is blocked out and cannot meet your need?"

For every man, woman, and child, when He passed through the cross, He said, "If you can understand this grace, He was made to be poor for your sakes, that through the substitution of Himself in your poverty, you might inherit the kingdom and inherit what is in the kingdom from this day to the day you walk on the streets of gold."

The devil does not have the power to withhold it from you, no matter your condition, because law says when your faith pleases Him by believing He is, then He will be.

"Well, if I cannot receive it, who should I blame?"

You can go join all the religions that are blaming God. You can find them right down the street. That sure is not going to help you.

He who comes to God must believe that He is. He is what He said He is in your covenant. Second, when you diligently seek Him out for what He has said, He is a rewarder. By golly, He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

Now we are talking about giving your life to this. You cannot do anything diligently without paying the utmost attention to it. We are talking about the top of the list. We are talking about priorities. He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him out in His positional truth. When you allow Him to become to you what He said He is, it pleases Him, because that is why He sent Jesus to the cross.

It pleases Him.

In this chapter, Hebrews 11, He talked about men who pleased God: Enoch, one of my favorites, Noah. This man pleased God to the condemnation of an entire world.

As long as He is talking about this kind of faith that pleases God, let us back up and look at what He really said about it.

Hebrews 11:1:

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for. Now faith is the substance of things hoped for.

Tell me, how does faith come? Faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God. Faith that comes by hearing and hearing by the Word is the substance of the thing I am hoping for.

If the hope in my soul has not been programmed by the Word of God, it cannot receive the substance of faith. If I am slated to die in six months by a doctor from cancer or something, faith only comes one way: by hearing and hearing what the Word of God said about my problem. Therefore, the hope in my soul must be programmed by the Word, or faith cannot come and put substance to it.

Most of our hope has been destroyed by the world, by religion, by well-meaning friends and doctors who are trying to console you or save your life.

Sometimes I am classified as a hard preacher, but I know how bad the devil is. Jesus said he only comes for one reason in three parts: to steal, kill, and destroy. All he does is kill. His light has gone out. He does not do anything else. He does not know anything else. He is not good at anything else. All he does is kill. Even if you misjudge him, he will kill you.

Do yourself a favor. When Jesus said, "Be wise as serpents and harmless as doves," do yourself a favor. He would not say "wise as serpents" if Satan did not have a whole arsenal full of weaponry that can only be defeated by the wisdom of God. He is not stupid.

Do you think Satan is going to use witchcraft on you? Am I going to draw a pentagram on the floor, grab a worshiper, put him down, and stab him in the heart? Would you turn to your neighbor and say, "Pardon me if I am wrong, and I do not want to be judgmental or anything, but do you think that was part of a Jesus Christ worship service?"

Of course not. The devil says, "You are a smart fellow. You follow the Holy Ghost. Religious person, the act of witchcraft is not going to deceive you, so why bother?" If the devil is going to deceive you, he has to go way up the line and trick you into dying young or something.

He said to be wise as a serpent and harmless as a dove.

If the hope in my soul has not been programmed by the Word, then faith cannot put substance to it, because now faith is the substance of the thing I am hoping for. I may be hoping for healing from terminal cancer, but if the hope in me is not constructed by the Word, which declares He bore my sicknesses and carried my pains, then faith cannot put substance to it because there is nothing there.

My doctor says I am going to die. You say I am going to die. Religion says I am going to die. My hope is full of damage, and it will not receive the substance of faith.

Notice what He went on to say about the man, woman, or child who comes to God with faith that pleases Him:

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

For by it the elders obtained a good report.

Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God, so that things which are seen were not made of things which do appear.

Then He goes on to say:

By faith Enoch was translated...

And in the sixth verse:

But without faith it is impossible to please him...

Then look what He said about Noah in verse 7:

By faith Noah, being warned of God of things not seen as yet, moved with fear, prepared an ark to the saving of his house; by the which he condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith.

One thing that confused me as we pass in review here was that third verse. He is talking about the annals of faith and all these powerful men of God in the Old Testament who pleased God by faith. Noah moved in fear of something he could not yet see, condemned the world, and became an heir of righteousness by faith. These men changed their worlds. They obtained a good report by faith.

I could never understand the third verse:

Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God...

I remember how the faith men, when we came on the scene, tried to outdo each other. "You can say to this mountain, doubt not in your heart, and you will have what you say with your mouth." Then we stretched it out as far as we could into confession. We broke all these verses down with one thing in mind: you need to fill your words with faith and confess them.

Some of us faith teachers really stretched some of these verses. We really wanted them to say what we wanted them to say. In this third verse, most translated it as though God stood on the edge of eternity and filled His words with faith. "By faith we understand the worlds were framed by the Word of God." So God stood on the edge of the universe, filled His words with faith, and said, "Worlds, be!" Then all of a sudden His faith-filled words, which were containers of faith, went out into the universe and created worlds. Everything He described came into existence.

Let me tell you something about God. He does not walk in love. He is love. He does not walk in faith. He is. He is faith.

Even after God spoke it, somebody had to go do it. With you, that can be understood because you are just a little human being standing there, but He did give you access to faith. So you fill your words with faith and speak it, and then somebody has to go out there and do it.

God did not just stand there, speak the world into existence, watch it, and say, "Man, did you see that?" He did it. The substance came from His person that the worlds were framed on. Somebody had to do it.

Then I thought, "I understand this verse because it says by faith we understand the worlds were framed by the Word of God. I was not there on the edge of eternity. I did not get to watch Him do this. Since I was not there, I have to understand it by faith."

I said, "Yes, God, I can believe You created. I understand by faith that the worlds were framed by the Word of God."

But then the verse did not fit in the chapter. The verse did not fit in context.

Finally it dawned on me. What did He say about Noah? Noah moved in fear of what he could not yet see, and he changed his whole world. He condemned the whole world and became one of the first heirs of righteousness by faith.

Noah changed his whole world. What Hebrews was saying is this: we understand that these men who passed through their generations framed their worlds by faith. "Worlds" plural was not cosmos. It was talking about the many worlds or generations that these men of God, like Moses, walked through and changed by faith that came to God believing He is.

They came before God, whole nations against a single man, moved by Someone they could not see, and changed their whole generation because they came to God believing that He is. What they could not see framed things that did appear. They changed their generations. This is what He was talking about.

Now He is talking to you. This is what He is saying in the exhortation He has now given to you and me in our covenant. These annals of faith were talking about Old Testament saints; now He is talking about your covenant. He is bringing it into present tense.

He says, "If this man is going to please God like these men pleased God when they changed their generation, he who comes to God must believe that He is, that He is everything God said He was to Moses when He said, 'I AM.' You must believe that He is everything in your covenant to you that He said He was in Moses' covenant to him. You must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him."

Let us take it to this level of diligently seeking. Every one of you has the potential to change things, for things that appear are only temporary. Things that appear are not eternal but subject to change. He who comes to Me and believes that I am has the essence to bring the change, for that which is temporary must give way to that which is eternal.

Hallelujah. God, I like that.

Let us take it into the first step of diligently seeking Him. I have a bill I cannot overcome. I am on the edge of bankruptcy. My body has declared war on me. Two weeks ago I had a growth come up the size of an egg. It was almost delirious, and it is gone. I am back. Hallelujah.

Your body has declared war on you. Your finances have declared war on you. Your emotions have declared war on you. You are a dirty dog and did not even do anything wrong. Welcome to the club.

The men and women who do exploits rise above that mass. The ones who do not just sit around for the rest of their lives feeling sorry for themselves. Sure, there are the milk stages and the comfort stages, but for God's sake, do not stay there. Put away childish things and go on into maturity.

We are going to show you how to diligently seek God until He is able to deliver to you faith that pleases Him, the kind that causes your body to come online and changes temporary circumstances while He works an eternal change in your character.

Glory be to God.

To do that, we have to explore two levels of faith. To explore that, go to Ephesians 5.

You believe that He is. He is. He is I AM. To have faith that pleases Him, I must believe that He is what He said He is in my covenant. If I cannot believe it, I must have enough respect for the Word of God to diligently seek Him until I do. I do not care what it costs me. It will not cost me as much as the disease. Amen.

Go to Ephesians 5. I love this. Do you know where He started talking to me about Ephesians 5? In Russia. I stepped out there and was preaching on faith. I had a translator, and all of a sudden, right in the middle of this translation, God started talking to me about this verse.

I felt like saying, "God, do You not know I am trying to preach to these people through a translator, and You are dropping this heavy revelation knowledge on me?" I could only get a couple of statements out, and I had to go back to milk.

It was fun. He got me on track, and then from then on it finished up in my spirit. You cannot pray in the Holy Ghost without getting messed up. God starts talking to you, your whole life goes to pieces, and then He puts it back together, and you are stronger than you ever were.

Is that the truth? Can I see hands that believe that is the truth? Because it wakes your conscience up against what you are doing wrong. That is the first thing that happens.

Spend three months in prayer, and you think you are going to emerge some great spiritual giant that God will use in miracles. Instead, He keeps talking to you about the things He wants you to get rid of over and over again. When you finally get rid of them, that is called edification. Is that not horrible? What kind of faith is that, putting the old man to death?

I think one of the longest things that hung on me was exaggeration, lying, and things like that. Of course, you do not do that.

The kid answers the phone: "Who is it?"

"It is that woman."

You know she wants to talk for about two hours. "Wait until I slip out the door and tell them I am not here."

Then later you whip your kid for lying when they were taught by a pro.

Then He says that to stand against the wiles of the devil, you have to put the armor on. The first piece of armor is your loins girded about with truth. Later the devil jumps in your family and finances, and you say, "I rebuke you, devil." He says, "You rebuke me when you quit lying, because then you have the armor that stands up against me."

You prayed three months in tongues and figured people should go down in masses when you just pray and say, "I love you in Jesus' name." But instead your conscience just antagonizes you when you exaggerate. Finally, you come to the place where you cannot keep praying and keep lying.

"God, what do You want me to give up?"

"By all means, go on lying."

You get so tormented you have to give one or the other up.

Now I can tell you something else. This old-time saint was talking to somebody about how she was going to sue a person who damaged her health for a considerable amount of money, thousands and thousands of dollars. Something is wrong with her, and she thinks this other person did something on their place that drifted over and caused her problem. So she is going to take them to court until she gets money out of them for her damaged health.

This same person claims to be an intercessor. Do you know what an intercessor is? An intercessor is somebody God slips in between people trying to get to hell. They would get there except for one reason: you are in the way.

Let me tell you something. It is impossible, because you cannot destroy one person's life by pretending to save another. If you decide to sue him, you have decided not to testify to him. So you will send him to hell but stand in the gap for the other one? You do not have the capacity.

Who wants to jump up and shout? Anybody?

I cannot go on. It is getting so good on me. You had better jump to your feet and shout about the Word a little bit. Say, "Thank You for Your Word." I want to hear it louder than that. You are quiet because it bore witness with you. That is why you are quiet.

Now shout a little more. "Thank You for Your Word." Glory.

"Man, you do not know how to run business, Brother Roberson."

I do not want to run it the way you run it. The whole system could collapse, and you will not have any more faith than you did when you sued that guy. Then where are you going to go?

My testimony is not for sale. I esteem preaching to that man for five minutes as worth more than the fifty thousand I could get out of him in twenty-four hours. If it is a decision between witnessing to him or suing him for fifty thousand, I will witness. Otherwise, your testimony is for sale.

If you are going to destroy a person, forget about intercession. For intercession, you have to have a capacity. If you have the capacity to destroy, you do not have the capacity for intercession. You think you do, but you are probably crying over your own problems.

Did you shout? I could not hear. Still a little puny.

Yes, that is edification. He will get you where you give that stuff up. You have been edified.

I thought it was a feeling. No, no, no. It is a transformation to the Word. That is edification.

My God, I think I am going to make this my home church.

You can be seated. Now go to Ephesians 5.

Let us find out about this, beginning with verse 17. We will talk about these two levels of faith now. The two levels exist in Hebrews 11:6: "He that comes to God must believe that He is," first level; "and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him," second level. He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him for the first level.

So there are two levels of faith in that verse. Now we are going to talk about those two levels and the diligently seeking part. In other words, "Brother Roberson, I have been in the ministry for a while and in faith, and I do not want to seem ignorant, but would you mind telling me how to put one foot in front of the other?"

Okay.

Verse 17:

Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.

Let us pick a disease. It has to be something He sovereignly delivered you from: sin, sickness, or poverty. Let us say hypothetically that the doctor just told me cancer is going to terminate me in six months.

If I am going to come to God with this problem, first I must believe that He is what He said He is in His Word. So the first thing I seek out is verse 17: "Be not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is."

Being faith people, I do not need to tell you what He is in your covenant concerning healing. He has borne your sicknesses and carried your pains. Of course, I could go into that covenant and preach many nights just on healing. But you know the same Jesus who bore your sins also took

upon Himself your sicknesses and carried your pains. He literally laid them on His back like a stack of wood on a burro and exported them, dying under the penalty of them in your place.

You were crucified with Him, which means when He died under the penalty of your disease, you died of that disease with Him. That stripped every disease known to mankind of its power to kill you, because it killed you once when you died with Him.

As my substitute, He bore my sins, and we understand that. The reason I am going to heaven is because He was made to be sin for me, and now I am the righteousness of God in Christ. He was made to be sin for me, that I might be made the righteousness of God.

Well, He was made to be sick. He bore my sicknesses and carried my pains. Why? Because just as He was my substitute for sin in the whole universe, He was the only qualified Redeemer to be my substitute. In order to take my penalty, He Himself had to be sin-free.

As my substitute in the eyes of God, when He was crucified, it was the same as me being crucified. Therefore, when He died under the penalty of cancer, multiple sclerosis, and every disease known to mankind, I died with Him. That means I already died of cancer once when I died with Him. As my substitute, I was already penalized with cancer, with multiple sclerosis, with sugar diabetes. I already died of every disease known to mankind when I died with Him.

Therefore there is no disease on planet earth that has the authority to come to my household and kill me, because I already died of it once when I died with Jesus.

So we understand, not being unwise concerning His will, that He bore my sicknesses and carried my pains. I establish myself in that wisdom, and I approach God knowing that He is what He said He is in my covenant. I approach Him with that Word, and that pleases Him.

The next step, verse 18, says:

And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;

It is funny, a lot of you know a lot about that. Obviously they did in Paul's day. How many of you know anything about being drunk with wine to excess? Let me see your little hand. He knew what to use to get you to understand teaching, did He not?

My God, my old friends after I got saved continued to drink. They would come staggering and breathing all over you. Some of the old winos had been born again and filled with the Holy Ghost in earlier days, and that is all they could talk about. They used to testify on the street and hand out tracts. Every time they got drunk, they would come and look you up wherever you were and want to tell you how spiritual they used to be, because that was the only conscience in their heart worth anything. When their senses shut down, that was the only thing that got out.

A falling-down drunk is easy to recognize.

This is the way I used that verse. For twenty-one years I made passing reference to it: "Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit." I would be working the prayer line. People would be falling down under the power, and they would get up drunk and stagger off to their seats. We would say, "Look at that, drunk on the new wine."

Sometimes I would get so out of it that I would be falling around. That was before I learned how to really let the power pass through me. I let it back up.

But God began to show me that there is a practical command here. Do not be drunk with wine, wherein is excess; be filled with the Spirit.

What does a drunk man do? His senses are brought under another influence. The problem may still be there, but he is not responding to it the same way. The Lord is saying, "Do not use wine to escape. Be filled with the Spirit until your senses and your emotions come under the influence of the Holy Ghost."

Then the next verse explains how:

Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord.

You minister to your own soul. You speak to yourself. You sing to the Lord. You worship. You stand before Him and say, "Father, You are my Father. I want to tell You a couple thousand times how much I love You. I do not want anything. I just want to stand here and tell You how much I love You."

In doing so, you minister to Him, and then you begin to bring His will out: "You are forever the same, yesterday, today, and forever. You change not. You have exalted Your Word above Your name. Therefore You bore my sicknesses and carried my pains. Listen to me, soul: I am healed."

When we first taught confession, it troubled me because I could not see how saying it once was any different from saying it ten thousand times. I said, "God, are You deaf or hard of hearing? On the ten-thousandth time You come and heal me? Why can I not just say it once? I believe it."

It is not God you are moving. You are ministering to yourself in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs because you are the one with the hope that cannot believe He is.

My ten thousand confessions were not like the heathen who believed they would be heard for their much speaking. Give me a break. How shall He who spared not His own Son not with Him freely give you all things? He is like that German shepherd on the end of the leash that smelled a drug dealer behind the wall and is negotiating with the police officer: "Please turn me loose. Give me five minutes before you come in. I have been pinned up in this canine car all day long."

God is like that German shepherd on the end of the leash, struggling to get into your problem. But he who comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

It is not the difference between one confession and ten thousand. It is because you are ministering to your own soul. Eventually your soul will transform you to what you subject yourself to the most. That is why our two hours of teaching a week is not enough. Your hope can be so damaged that it is not powerful enough to stand against twenty-four hours of negativism, doctors, and a stream of relatives who have come to see you for the last time.

It is not enough. You may have to go before God fifty thousand times in worship and minister to your own soul until your hope is repaired, until you cross the line from faith that cannot receive the substance to faith that can. That is the kind that pleases God.

There are two levels of faith. The first is that when you come to God, you must believe that He is. The second is that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him. Diligently. He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him for who He is.

If it pleases Him that He spared not His own Son, then it pleases Him that you will diligently give yourself until you believe that He is. That is fellowship to Him.

Most faith people walk in level one. We admire the Word. We adhere to it as absolute truth. We adhere to it as the final say-so. Do you have a covenant? Yes. Are you healed? Yes, most certainly. We do not have any trouble recognizing and adhering to the fact that the Word of God is true and is the final say-so.

We admire it. We worship it. We love it. We love the fact that we are faith people and that we do have a covenant.

But folks, most pastors will get up and preach that covenant and do not care enough to find out about it for all the sick children in the church. Most of us walk in level one: "I admire it. I love it. I believe it to be so. It is absolutely true."

We admire it as truth, but we do not respect it enough to take the steps necessary to subject our senses and emotions underneath the Word until our emotions need no outside stimulation but the Word of God to believe we are healed, and our senses need no other source but the Word to believe it is done.

Most of us admire it and adhere to it, but if the disease does not change in our body, we do not diligently seek Him. We do not respect the Word enough or believe it enough to diligently present ourselves under it and minister to our own soul, even if it took ten hours a day.

For God's sake, what else is important to you?

First you come to Him believing that He is. That is first. Positionally, He is your answer. You have to believe that, or you will never get to level two. Level two is diligently seeking Him until you receive what it said.

Admiring it is not enough. You have to respect it enough to subject your senses and your emotions under it until they are trained to receive and believe what it has said about your problem. It does not matter how long it takes. That is called diligent.

In closing, I would like to think that I am always somewhere in God that I am not, and I get that proven in the face of adversity. I hate those kinds of lessons. I like the Word better. I get them proved to me on a regular basis.

All of my boys and my girls are basically healthy. There is nothing in any of them that is threatening their life. Most of us with a resident disease will be passive about it. It is not going to kill you in ten days, so why be diligent? We let resident things move in.

I am telling you, whether you can believe He is or not, you have a covenant. If you are going to have faith that pleases Him, you must believe that He is. If you want results, you must believe that He is a rewarder. You will get your answer. Be not unwise. I will get my answer.

Now, I still say, if one of my children was born deformed, never able to use their legs, never able to communicate to me because their larynx and other things were also deformed, I would still know what they wanted because they are my child.

I saw a special on a man who trained with his child in a wheelchair to run races. When he mountain climbed, he hoisted him up with him. He took him everywhere with him because he loved him. He did not spare him anything the rest of the family was doing, which is commendable for the world.

Most people say, "I do not want them in sight. I have my good-looking life, money in my pocket, and my car."

To operate in this kind of faith, we think we have to have it together enough not to have any problems. "Please get them out of my sight." There you are, talking about the good life while you are wiping slobber off your child at a restaurant.

How about him? He is called to as good a life as you are. He has a calling to answer. He has a reward waiting. For God's sake, what is this covenant good for? Only for people who have it together enough to operate it? You have to be born perfect?

The Church is failing these people. We all jump up and preach mighty faith. "We have a covenant." Yeah, yeah, yeah. Why do we let it go on? We have a covenant. Why do we skirt around the edges? Why do we not explore it to the nth degree?

He is, or He is not. If He is, for God's sake, let us have a revival.

Now, I have not faced this, but I think this is the difference between phileo and agape. Maybe phileo and agape together, human love and God's love working together. That means your own child coupled with agape might push you that far, but with somebody else's baby, no phileo presses you.

Most of us cannot even put our own differences aside enough to establish a prayer life. The Church is sitting around saying, "God is going to pull revival out." One of the biggest deceptions is waiting for it instead of causing it.

What does your Word say? What did the early church elders do that caused revival? They continually gave themselves to one thing. Why have we remodeled it? They gave themselves continually to the Word of God and prayer. What have we done to it?

If my child were that way, my job would not mean that much to me because he is not with me and would never inherit my business. It would be very hard for me to sit through any entertainment the world has to offer.

What do we do? We go to psychologists who teach us how to cope. A bunch of preachers say, "God does not call me to do that." Do not tell me He does not call you to do that. Go get a translator and tell the child, "God did not call me to do that." Do not tell me I do not have a problem.

What would I do? My job would not mean anything. Achievements would not mean anything. Oh sure, my kids are going to go to heaven. That is not enough.

What makes me want to stick my finger down my throat and throw up is these preachers who come and say things like, "I would not answer the call until God drowned my children in the pool, and then there was nothing between me and Him, so I answered it."

That is self-exalted. He thinks his life is worth so much that God sacrifices entire human beings for an attitude correction. He thinks the life of an entire human being is forfeited, along with their whole reward, just to adjust his attitude. What do you think you are worth?

What do you think you would do if I could not support myself because I had to pray? I would probably go get one of those cans. I am speaking hypothetically, just how far I think I would go. You know those cans with a picture saying, "Help my child get an operation," that they put in little convenience stores? Have you ever put money in them? I do. A lot of them are crooks, yes. Some of them are not, and I thank God for the ones that are not, because they help that child get an operation.

If my child could not be helped, I would not lie. I would put a can up and say, "Would you please help me get help for my child?" Then I would take the money out of the can and go pay the rent and buy groceries for my wife. At six o'clock every evening, I would be in the prayer closet ministering to my own soul for such an impossible miracle that I was so drunk in the Spirit and so overpowered in my reasonings that Jesus would walk in the room and give my child's body back.

If you do not think He does things like that, ask Betty Baxter.

Move from level one, from admiring it and adhering to its truth, to respecting this positional truth enough to do what is necessary to diligently please Him. He will come. He will come and reward you. His covenant will come alive in you as it did in Moses when he was backed up against the Red Sea and there was no way out.

Do not be drunk with wine. The devil says, "You will have to run from this problem." But be filled with the Holy Ghost. He will cause you to look at the problem the same way the drunk man looked at his: it does not bother you anymore.

Let us worship God.